

The Southern Report.

Six communes, verifiable figures, and what Luxembourg does not publish.
Esch-sur-Alzette · Differdange · Dudelange · Bettembourg · Sanem · Pétange.

6	1,641	50.8 : 1	0
COMMUNES ANALYSED	ACTIVE LISTINGS COUNTED	DUDELANGE'S SALE-TO-RENT RATIO	INVENTED FIGURES

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Real estate agent · Luxembourg — sourced analysis, verifiable method

Reference data: July 2026 · gathered 10/08/2026 · valid for one quarter

METHOD

What this report refuses to do

Luxembourg publishes no transaction register, no days-on-market, no absorption rate. This report marks those as absent rather than estimating them.

The figures that follow rest on two kinds of source: asking prices (immotop.lu, athome.lu — what sellers want) and the Observatoire de l’Habitat’s aggregated notarial prices (what actually gets paid, published quarterly with a lag). The gap between the two is itself information: in Esch-sur-Alzette it is roughly €950/m².

METRIC EXPECTED BY ANGLO-SAXON MODELS	STATUS IN LUXEMBOURG
True median sale price	impossible — no public register
Sale-to-list price ratio	impossible
% sold above asking	impossible
Average days on market	not published
Months of inventory by commune	not published
Rental vacancy rate	not published by commune

■ An honest analyst tells you what they do not know. It is how you spot one.

OVERVIEW

Six communes, three speeds

The south is not one market. In July 2026, neighbouring communes are moving in opposite directions.

Bettembourg and Sanem are correcting from recent peaks (September and December 2025). Dudelange and Pétange have already corrected and are stabilising. Esch and Differdange are drifting gently. Three different phases of the cycle, fifteen kilometres apart.

COMMUNE	ASKING PRICE	1 YEAR	RENT	RENT 1 YR	SALE/RENT
Esch-sur-Alzette	€7,149/m ²	-1.31 %	€28.17	+3.22 %	17.6 : 1
Bettembourg	€7,070/m ²	-3.64 %	€22.97	+1.10 %	22.3 : 1
Sanem	€6,773/m ²	-2.99 %	€25.38	+4.53 %	46.2 : 1
Dudelange	€6,628/m ²	+0.52 %	€25.76	+12.34 %	50.8 : 1
Differdange (Nieder Korn)	€6,317/m ²	-0.91 %	€28.27	+7.53 %	30 : 1
Pétange	€6,276/m ²	+0.18 %	€25.85	+8.61 %	27.4 : 1

Sources — immotop.lu communal series (July 2026) · Observatoire de l'Habitat (April 2026). Asking prices, not sale prices.

THE DOMINANT FACT

The rental shortage is a legal artefact

Across the south, for-sale stock dwarfs rental stock. That is not demographics — it is the law.

254 / 5

Dudelange has 254 properties for sale against 5 to rent — the most extreme imbalance I have measured in Luxembourg. The statutory rent cap (5 % of revalued invested capital, law of 21/09/2006) compresses yield to the point where owners choose selling over letting. The mechanical result: where there is least to rent, rents rise fastest. Dudelange shows +12.34 % rent growth in one year.

COMMUNE	FOR SALE	TO RENT	RATIO	RENT, 1 YR
Dudelange	254	5	50.8 : 1	+12.34 %
Sanem	231	5	46.2 : 1	+4.53 %
Pétange	274	10	27.4 : 1	+8.61 %
Bettembourg	89	4	22.3 : 1	+1.10 %

Draft law no. 8184 would cut the cap from 5 % to 3.5 % on new leases. Not passed, not retroactive — and no serious rental decision should be made before its fate is known.

THE LESSON OF SCALE

The commune average is a statistical lie

In the south of 2026, dispersion between localities of one commune exceeds dispersion between communes.

Fourteen points of divergence in one year between Belvaux and Ehlerange — inside the same 25 km² commune. Belvaux touches the Belval campus; Ehlerange is furthest from it. In Bettembourg two localities lose more than 10 % while a third does not move. In Esch, gross yield runs from 2.29 % (Grenz) to 5.05 % (Al-Esch) depending on the neighbourhood.

LOCALITY (COMMUNE)	€/M²	1 YEAR
Belvaux (Sanem)	€6,926	+2.9 %
Soleuvre (Sanem)	€6,741	-5.7 %
Ehlerange (Sanem)	€6,035	-11.0 %
Fennange (Bettembourg)	€7,714	-10.6 %
Abweiler (Bettembourg)	€7,187	0.0 %
Pétange locality	€6,297	+1.3 %
Lamadelaine (Pétange)	€6,054	-5.2 %

Any decision taken on a commune average is taken on a number that describes no real address.

THE REAL COST

A €545,000 property commits €588,600

Acquisition costs are not a footnote. They are the basis of any serious calculation — and the property's use changes everything.

As a primary residence, the Bëllegen Akt erases up to €40,000 of duty per buyer (amount confirmed by the law of 03/07/2025; a 16/07/2026 release announces €45,000, not consolidated at the time of writing — confirm with the notary). Cash at signing then falls to around €5,450. On a rental the credit does not apply: budget roughly €152,600 in cash on the same property at 80 % LTV.

ITEM	AMOUNT
Property price	€545,000
Registration duty (6 %)	€32,700
Transcription duty (1 %)	€5,450
Notary (~1 %)	€5,450
Capital actually invested	€588,600

Buying to live and buying to let is the same property and two operations with nothing in common. Thirty times more cash in the second case.

YOUR FOUR CHECKS

Before any offer in the south

None is spectacular. Together they prevent almost every unpleasant surprise I have seen land after signature.

01 · The definitive energy certificate

Not the provisional one. Across the comparables captured in Esch, the gap between unrenovated and renovated stock reaches +38 % per m². The premium rests on a document — demand it.

02 · The managing agent's budget and reserve fund

A five-unit co-ownership splits a roof across five shares instead of thirty. The governance is simple; the invoice is not.

03 · The parcel's zoning

PAG, PAP, flood zones (the Alzette and the Chiers cross the basin), and CASIPO — the register of potentially polluted sites, unavoidable on a former steelworks basin. Fifteen minutes on geoportail.lu.

04 · The tax amounts, with the notary

Bëllegen Akt, capital gains regime, deduction caps: three figures that moved recently. No simulation replaces a confirmation.

These are not investor precautions. They are the minimum for buying a home — and almost nobody does all four.

SOURCES AND LIMITS

Check me

Every figure in this report carries its source. What Luxembourg does not publish is not estimated — it is stated.

Prices and stock: immotop.lu communal series, reference period July 2026, gathered 10/08/2026. Notarial prices: Observatoire de l'Habitat (April 2026). Rail: cfl.lu and station records. Schools: Inbd.lu, lbv.lu, lma.lu. Legal framework: law of 21/09/2006 (rent cap), law of 03/07/2025 (Bëllegen Akt), draft law no. 8184 (chd.lu, not passed). Asking prices are not sale prices. The figures in this report are valid for one quarter — beyond that, ask for the current edition.

■ A sourced number invites the reader to check. That is exactly why you source it.

■ Ayrton Silva · Luxembourg — for the current edition of this report or an analysis of your situation: write to me.

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